

Herald — WHATSAPP

Herald — WhatsApp Channel Setup Guide

What you can do now

Related

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Field	Value
Status	PLANNED — HRD-NNN (later iteration)
Spec ref	V3 §11 (later iteration)
Env vars (reserved)	HERALD_WHATSAPP_BUSINESS_TOKEN, HERALD_WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID, HERALD_WHATSAPP_VERIFY_TOKEN
Code	(not yet implemented)

WhatsApp Business API is reserved for a later iteration. Requires WhatsApp Business Account approval and a verified phone number; setup is significantly more involved than other messengers.

This guide is a **placeholder**. When the WhatsApp adapter lands as an HRD, this file will expand to the same step-by-step structure as [TELEGRAM.md](#): obtain credentials → set env vars → verify HealthCheck → verify Send → optional Subscribe → troubleshooting.

What you can do now

- Reserve the env-var names in your `.env` (commented out, per [../OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md](#)).
- Watch the HRD for status updates — it will move from open to code complete; awaiting live evidence to Fixed over its implementation lifecycle.
- If you have an urgent need for the WhatsApp channel, open an issue against the HRD asking for priority — operator-driven escalation is honored per the constitution.

Related

- OPERATOR_CREDENTIALS.md — the umbrella credentials guide with reserved env-var blocks for every planned channel
- TELEGRAM.md — the canonical live-channel guide shape (this file will mirror that structure when WhatsApp lands)
- Spec: V3 §11 (later iteration)